

SERVING PLAN 2 SERVING PLAN

Southwestern Beef Tostadas

with Cilantro-Lime Crema

We're skipping the fry and baking the tortillas for tonight's tostadas, a hands-free technique that saves time and cleanup. Once crispy and golden, they're piled high with Southwestern-spiced beef, bell pepper, and corn, then finished with a cool lime-spiked crema. Get your kitchen companion to stir the crema and drizzle over each tostada.

20–30 minutes 820 calories per serving

Plated.

Ingredients

- 12 ounces ground beef
- 1 each corn tortilla
- 1 red bell pepper
- ⅛ ounce cilantro, divided
- 1 lime, divided
- 1 red onion
- 1 can black beans
- ¼ cup corn
- 1 spice mix
  - ½ teaspoon chili powder
  - ½ teaspoon garlic powder
- 2 tablespoons tomato paste
- 2 packets sour cream

You'll need

olive oil
kosher salt
black pepper
10" medium high-sided pan
baking sheet

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking. Trust us—you'll be glad you did!

Using a slotted spoon will drain off any excess fat from the beef so it doesn't end up in your tostadas. Pouring the fat down the drain might damage your pipes—instead, pour it into a heatproof container once it's cooled slightly, and dispose in the garbage.

Build the tostadas just before you plan to serve so the tortillas stay crisp.

USDA recommends cooking ground beef to 160°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

1843-5700-2P



1. Cook beef

Preheat oven to 450°F. Pat **beef** dry with paper towel. Heat **½ tablespoon olive oil** in a medium high-sided pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **beef** and season with **½ teaspoon salt** and **black pepper** as desired. Cook, breaking up, until browned, about 5 minutes. Using a slotted spoon, transfer **beef** to a plate (see recipe tip). Wipe pan clean for Step 3.



2. Prepare ingredients

While beef cooks, rinse all produce. Halve **bell pepper** lengthwise, discarding seeds and stem; cut into ¼-inch pieces. Finely chop **cilantro** leaves and stems. Halve **lime**; cut **1 half** into wedges for serving. Peel **onion**, halve, and thinly slice. Drain and rinse **black beans**. Measure out **½ cup black beans** for the next step; save remainder for another recipe (like a big tray of nachos).



3. Finish beef

Return pan from beef to medium-high heat with **1 tablespoon olive oil**. When oil is shimmering, add **onion** and sauté, stirring occasionally, until softened, about 3 minutes. Add **corn**, **spice mix**, **bell pepper**, and **black beans** and cook, stirring, 2 minutes. Stir in **tomato paste**, **beef**, **¼ cup water**, **¾ teaspoon salt**, and **black pepper** as desired. Simmer until liquid is slightly reduced and flavors have melded, 3–5 minutes more. Remove pot from heat.



4. Bake tostadas

While beef simmers, on a baking sheet, arrange **tortillas** in a single layer and brush each with **¼ teaspoon olive oil**. Season with **⅛ teaspoon salt**. Bake until golden and crisp, 6–8 minutes.



5. Make cilantro-lime crema

While tostadas bake, in a small bowl, whisk together **sour cream**, **half of cilantro**, **juice of ½ lime**, **¼ teaspoon salt**, and **black pepper** as desired—this is a great task for your kitchen companion.



6. Plate beef tostadas

Once baked, transfer **tostadas** to serving plates and top with **Southwestern beef** (see recipe tip). Drizzle over **cilantro-lime crema** and garnish with **remaining cilantro** (or let your kitchen companion do this part). Serve with **lime wedges** for squeezing over. Dig in!

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